Nithya Rathinavelu

Lead UX / Product Designer

Enterprise SaaS · Mobile & Web · Design Systems · AI-Assisted Design · 7+ Years

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SUMMARY

Lead UX and Product Designer with 7+ years of experience owning end-to-end product design across complex enterprise SaaS, mobile, and web platforms. I work across the full design spectrum, from user research, information architecture, and interaction design to visual design, prototyping, and design systems, and I bring strategic product thinking and hands-on craft to every problem. I identify user and business opportunities that are not easily visible, translate complex requirements into simple, intuitive, and scalable solutions, and hold the quality bar through design reviews, critique, and close collaboration with product managers, engineers, and senior stakeholders. I built and own a design system from scratch, mentor a team of 8 designers, use generative AI tools to accelerate design and prototyping, and have shipped multiple AI-powered product experiences to production. I am equally comfortable shaping product direction at the strategic level and getting into the details of interaction states, edge cases, and visual craft.

SKILLS

End-to-End Product Design: User research, information architecture, interaction design, visual design, prototyping, usability testing, design documentation, edge cases, error states, responsive and mobile-first design, WCAG accessibility

Design Systems: Design system ownership from scratch; 80+ reusable components, tokens, typography, colour, spacing, iconography, and motion; an AI component layer; Figma variables and auto-layout; Storybook; cross-team adoption and governance

AI Experience Design: Agentic workflows, conversational interfaces, human-in-the-loop and confirmation patterns, AI behaviour standards; shipped multiple AI-powered product experiences

AI-Assisted Design: Generative AI tools for ideation, prototyping, and research synthesis; vibe coding using Cursor, GitHub Copilot, Lovable, and v0; Figma AI, Midjourney, Adobe Firefly, Claude, ChatGPT

User Research & Validation: Mixed-methods user research, in-depth user interviews, contextual inquiry, journey mapping, usability testing (moderated and unmoderated), surveys, JTBD, opportunity mapping, continuous discovery, service blueprints

Visual & Interaction Craft: Pixel-perfect UI, hierarchy, typography, colour systems, grids, spacing, micro-interactions, motion design, visual storytelling, high-fidelity prototyping, brand-aligned design

Strategic Product Thinking: Translating business goals and user needs into clear product direction, roadmap influence, OKR contribution, design-led decision making, stakeholder alignment, executive presentations

Leadership & Collaboration: Mentoring a team of 8 designers; design critique facilitation; working with product managers, engineers, researchers, data, marketing, and senior leadership; cross-functional workshops and co-design sessions

Tools: Figma (advanced), Cursor, GitHub Copilot, Lovable, Vercel, v0, Claude, ChatGPT, Midjourney, Adobe Firefly, Adobe Creative Suite, Protopie, Framer, FigJam, Miro, Storybook, Jira, Confluence, Notion, Hotjar

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead UX / Product Designer · Melento (formerly Signdesk) · Bengaluru

Apr 2024 – Present

- Own end-to-end product design across a growing suite of enterprise SaaS applications, leading from discovery and user research through interaction design, visual design, prototyping, and production delivery.
- Translate complex business and user needs into simple, scalable, and intuitive product experiences across web and mobile, covering edge cases, error states, and accessibility requirements on every shipped feature.
- Built and maintain the Melento design system from scratch: 80+ reusable components, design tokens, typography, colour, spacing, and motion guidelines, adopted as the shared UI standard across all product teams. Extended it with an AI layer of 45+ components and behaviour rules for AI features.
- Designed and shipped multiple AI-powered product experiences to production, including agentic AI workflows, conversational interfaces, intelligent dashboards, and human-in-the-loop interaction models.
- Led the design of a low-code workflow builder from scratch in 4 months, designing core parts hands-on while guiding a junior designer; now live with customers, letting admins build, test, and run their own workflows without developers.
- Use vibe coding with Cursor, GitHub Copilot, Lovable, and v0 to take designs from Figma to deployed web applications and Figma plugins without engineering dependency.
- Lead user research, usability testing, and continuous discovery, embedding lightweight research touchpoints in every sprint to keep the team grounded in real user behaviour.

- Define and track UX success metrics alongside product KPIs (task completion, error rates, time-on-task) and use findings to drive strategic design improvements and OKR contributions.
- Present design work from sprint reviews through quarterly executive briefings; shape org and process decisions by providing regular guidance to product and design leadership.
- Facilitate design thinking workshops, co-design sessions, and design sprints with 15+ cross-functional stakeholders to align teams around a shared product vision.
- Mentor a team of 8 designers through structured critique and direct feedback, setting quality standards and building a culture of craft and continuous improvement.

Senior UX / Product Designer · Melento (formerly Signdesk) · Bengaluru *Apr 2021 – Mar 2024*

- Led end-to-end UX and product design for a complex enterprise SaaS platform used by 50,000+ active users across web and mobile, owning the full design lifecycle from research through production.
- Designed data-heavy dashboards, operational workflows, and complex multi-step enterprise interfaces with strong information architecture and visual design, reducing average time-on-task by 20% on core redesigned flows.
- Ran moderated usability testing and qualitative research as a regular sprint cadence, pairing findings with product analytics to make evidence-based design decisions.
- Collaborated closely with product managers, engineers, and data teams to translate compliance and business requirements into user-centred interaction models without degrading the experience.
- Contributed to and evolved the design system, establishing shared component patterns and documentation standards that became the foundation of the full system built as lead.
- Improved task completion rates by 25% on redesigned core flows; reduced post-release design regressions by approximately 40% through structured design QA before every release.

UX Designer · Melento (formerly Signdesk) · Bengaluru *2019 – Mar 2021*

- Designed enterprise dashboards and internal tools across multiple product lines, building strong foundations in interaction design, information architecture, visual craft, and accessible design on high-frequency, operationally demanding products.
- Contributed to Melento's first shared component library, establishing reusable patterns and documentation standards that became the base of the design system built out fully as lead.

Freelance UX Designer · Independent · Multiple Clients *Aug 2018 – Sep 2019*

- Designed SaaS dashboards and e-commerce products for four clients simultaneously, owning user research, wireframes, visual design, prototyping, and developer handoff solo on each engagement.
- Built strong presentation and stakeholder communication skills by translating design decisions into business outcomes for non-design founders and executive audiences.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Department Excellence Award · Melento (formerly Signdesk): UX impact on enterprise product quality and team output

Milestone Award · Melento (formerly Signdesk): Design system adoption across the product

CERTIFICATIONS

Google UX Design Certificate

UX & Interaction Design (Interaction Design Foundation)

EDUCATION

MBA, Human Resource Management · Bharathiyar University, Coimbatore

Bachelor of Computer Applications (BCA) · Vysya College, Salem